needed a consistent way to ensure that each API call adhered to organizational policy. Externally, customers like Kate and Jack wanted to connect their own tools to the Customer Collaboration platform, but without sharing passwords or exposing more data than necessary.

The solutions appeared different on the surface. Inside ACME's infrastructure, authorization took place at the API gateway, within the service mesh, and through per-service proxies. Outside, access was granted via OAuth, with Kate using the Authorization Code Grant and CustCo's Task App employing the Client Credentials Grant. Despite these differences, both pathways ended the same way: each API request was converted into a PARC request and evaluated according to Cedar policies.

That consistency is the heart of ACME's story. OAuth tokens and scopes define the outer boundary, specifying which APIs a client is allowed to access. Cedar handles the internal logic, determining which actions are permitted on specific resources. By externalizing decision-making and evaluating policies at runtime, ACME accomplishes two goals simultaneously:

- Developers no longer needed to duplicate authorization logic in each service.
- Customers can safely integrate third-party tools without granting broad or fragile access.

From microservices to third-party integrations, ACME learned that API authorization is more than just checking tokens or enforcing scopes. It is about integrating policy into every request path, ensuring that the same rules apply whether the caller is a person, a service, or an external application. With Cedar as the decision engine and OAuth as the delegation protocol, ACME unified internal enforcement and external delegation into a single, coherent policy story.

The next chapter shifts focus from APIs to the context that policies rely on. We've seen Cedar enforce rules consistently across gateways, meshes, proxies, and OAuth-protected APIs, but what information does Cedar (or any policy engine) need to make those decisions? We'll examine how principals and resources are represented as entities, what external signals influence